

Parking lot USB exercise

Contents	<i>The USB drive seems to be of our HR manager Jorge, inside the USB we can find both personal and work-related files. Some personal files, like the “JB_Resume” file or the “Family photos” folder can contain sensitive PII information and they should be stored more securely.</i> <i>3 sensitive work-related files can be accessed via the USB, a “shift schedule” excel file and an “Employee budget” excel file are the most sensitive ones.</i> <i>My recommendation is that personal and work-related files should be stored in different, more secured, devices, because it’s not safe to store both of them in the same one.</i>
Attacker mindset	<i>The information stored inside the usb can be exploited and used by malicious actors and attackers in order to penetrate inside the company’s infrastructure.</i> <i>The “Employee budget” excel file could be accessed and used by an attacker in order to contact other employees and let them know how much everyone is paid, then exploit the difference in salary in order to convince some employees to share PII and sensitive data of the company in exchange for a payment.</i> <i>Some personal files like the Wedding list or the family photos folder could be used by an attacker to know PII information of all the family and relatives of Jorge, giving a big surface of attack for phishing and other cyberattacks to obtain information and data from the company.</i> <i>The “shift schedule” excel file could give away important information about the employee shift schedule and the opportunity to attackers to know the working hours of each employee in order to make cyber attacks impersonating the employee devices or the employee himself, in this way an attacker could complete an attack gaining access to sensitive data of the company.</i>

Risk analysis	<i>Inside this USB a malicious actor could easily hide malicious code to run one's you open a file, this code could infect the device and maybe move to the entire company's network, infecting devices and giving the attacker a big surface of attack working inside the company's network and collecting information.</i> <i>Another employee could easily unintentionally find the usb and open the files, creating a great risk for the company. Operational controls like awareness training could help to avoid this type of scenarios, by training the employees the right way to manage this type of situation.</i> <i>On a device like this a threat actor could find potentially sensitive information in order to prepare an attack to the company, from the shifting hours of the employees to their salaries and all the PII information around the jorge family. A technical control in order to protect assets should be put in place, creating at least a layer of security control to block the attacker from obtaining these information, like an encryption or an authentication system.</i>
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